banking services. Business owners who don't enforce the hijab law among their employees or customers face a fine of up to three months of their profits, and they may be banned from leaving the country or participating in public or online activities for up to two years. The new bill targets not only women, but also men who wear 'revealing clothing that shows parts of the body lower than the chest or above the ankles'. Finally, the law mandates that Iranian police must 'create and strengthen AI systems to identify perpetrators of illegal behaviour using tools such as fixed and mobile cameras'.[40] In coming years, many people might be living under total surveillance regimes that would make Ceauşescu's Romania look like a libertarian utopia.

VARIETIES OF SURVEILLANCE

When talking about surveillance, we usually think of state-run apparatuses, but to understand surveillance in the twenty-first century, we should remember that monitoring can take many other forms. Jealous partners, for example, have always wanted to know where their spouses were at every moment and demanded explanations for any little deviation from routines. Today, armed with a smartphone and some cheap software, they can easily establish marital dictatorships. They can monitor every conversation and every movement, record phone logs, track social media posts and web page searches, and even activate the cameras and microphones of a spouse's phone to serve as a spying device. The US-based National Network to End Domestic Violence found that more than half of domestic abusers used such stalkerware technology. Even in New York a spouse may find themselves monitored and restricted, as if they lived in a totalitarian state.[41]

A growing percentage of employees – from office workers to truck drivers – are also now being surveilled by their employers. Bosses can pinpoint where employees are at any moment, how much time they spend in the toilet, whether they read personal emails at work and how fast they complete each task.[42] Corporations are similarly monitoring their customers, wanting to know their likes and dislikes, to predict future behaviour and to evaluate risks and opportunities. For example, vehicles monitor their drivers' behaviour and share the data with the algorithms of the insurance companies, which raise the premiums they charge 'bad